Craig Feldman

Software Engineer

Cape Town, South Africa
+2773 424 9696 | craig@craigfeldman.com

SKILLS

Programming Languages: Typescript, Go, Kotlin, C#, SQL

Frameworks & Tools: Node.js, React, Docker, Kubernetes, Helm, Terraform, PostgreSQL, Redis, Kafka

Focus: Backend development, Distributed systems, Platform engineering, DevOps, Scalability, System performance optimisation, Developer enablement, Payments, Fintech,

EXPERIENCE

Stitch - *Senior Platform Engineer and Team Lead*

2021 - PRESENT

- Joined at early-stage startup phase and helped scale payments volume from ~500 daily transactions to **tens of thousands per hour**
- Led the **ground-up development of an enterprise-grade reporting dashboard**, enabling large clients to manage accounts and transactions at scale
- Directed the design and delivery of a **self-service onboarding and payments management platform** for SMEs, which grew into a standalone business domain generating **>$100k/month in revenue**
- Drove a **major architectural shift** in client configuration management, improving scalability and maintainability
- Built and maintained **bank and API integrations** (including reverse-engineering and host-to-host payment systems)
- Served as **engineering team lead**, mentoring developers, guiding technical decisions, and driving delivery across multiple domains
- Key member of the **platform engineering team**, responsible for scaling, developer enablement, CI/CD optimisation, and observability improvements
- Achieved **cost savings of >$15k/month** by optimising infrastructure efficiency while scaling to handle **hundreds of requests per second**
- Enhanced developer productivity by streamlining pipelines, reducing build/test cycle times, and improving monitoring and alerting systems

Luno - *Software Engineer – Payment Operations*

2020 - 2021

- Member of the cross-functional **Payment Operations team**, building internal systems to support fiat payment flows across wallets and exchanges
- Developed tools and services to **streamline fiat deposits and withdrawals**, improving reliability and efficiency of money movement
- Designed and implemented a system for **automatic reconciliation of fiat accounts**, reducing manual effort and operational risk
- Contributed to **internal frameworks and tooling** used across engineering teams, primarily in **Go**
- Worked closely with senior engineers and the tech leadership/executive team on **strategy, architecture, and operational improvements**

Over - *Software Engineer – Backend & Services*

2018 - 2019

- Early employee in the backend/services team, working primarily with **Kotlin** (services) and **TypeScript + Angular** (internal CMS)
- Responsible for the design, development, and maintenance of the **backend systems** powering a mobile-first graphic design platform (similar to Canva)
- **Supported rapid scaling** of the company from ~20 to over 150 employees, contributing to backend reliability during periods of high growth
- Delivered features enabling image and video editing on mobile devices, supporting millions of creative users worldwide
- Contributed to the company's growth and eventual **acquisition by GoDaddy** (later rebranded as GoDaddy Studio)

EDUCATION

University of Oxford, United Kingdom - *Msc Computer Science*

2016 - 2017

Full university-awarded academic scholarship (Standard Bank Africa Chairman's Scholarship). Graduated with distinction in practical work.

University of Cape Town, South Africa - *BBusSci Computer Science*

2012 - 2015

Graduated with distinction; Dean's Merit List (all years); multiple prizes and scholarships (including top computer science student).